

Elliot Preston

Technical Leader | Software Quality | Mobile Applications

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Professional Summary

Technical leader with deep software quality experience who progressed from technical support through QA to engineering leadership. Led an engineering team supporting 4,000+ white-label mobile applications across iOS and Android, with responsibility spanning quality, delivery, product priorities, and team development. Identifies risks early, investigates complex production issues, and leads initiatives from planning to production. Translates between customer-facing teams, product, and engineering.

Core Strengths

Technical Leadership • Quality Strategy • Risk-Based Testing • Release Readiness
Production Investigation & Root Cause Analysis • Test Automation • Sprint Planning & Prioritization
Requirements Clarification • Cross-Functional Coordination • Mobile Application Quality

Experience

Pushpay Tech Lead

Remote
March 2024 - July 2026

- Led sprint planning, quality strategy, and release readiness for a team of up to 10 engineers supporting React Native and native iOS and Android applications.
- Took on day-to-day product responsibilities when the team did not have dedicated product support, including backlog prioritization, defining scope and requirements, and making tradeoff decisions across competing initiatives.
- Coordinated daily production releases and concurrent engineering work, balancing team capacity, customer impact, regression risk, technical dependencies, and platform compliance.
- Led root-cause investigations for production issues across crashes, push notifications, app signing, WebViews, OS changes, and third-party libraries using logs, crash data, build records, SQL queries, and customer reports.
- Drove cross-functional platform initiatives across 4,000+ mobile apps, including React Native modernization, iOS and Android compliance, large-scale app resubmissions, analytics, release tooling, and legacy-system retirement planning.
- Mentored developers, QA engineers, contractors, and new hires while partnering with the Engineering Director on day-to-day team leadership, including coaching, performance input, and team development.
- Applied AI-assisted tools to technical investigation, code analysis, test planning and coverage, compliance research, and technical documentation.

Senior QA Engineer

Remote
April 2023 - March 2024

- Owned quality planning and release validation for customer-facing iOS and Android applications across devices, OS versions, customer configurations, and integrations.
- Designed and executed hands-on exploratory, regression, integration, and production-validation testing using real customer workflows to uncover usability issues, edge cases, and complex mobile failure modes.
- Translated evolving requirements and early designs into focused test strategies, risk and customer-impact questions, actionable technical findings, and release recommendations.
- Debugged and investigated complex defects using crash reporting, logs, SQL and Redash queries, build and configuration data, and direct collaboration with engineers.

Pushpay (continued)

QA Engineer II

Remote
October 2021 - April 2023

- Created and executed exploratory, regression, integration, and release tests; reproduced issues and verified fixes.
- Applied deep customer and product knowledge to inform risk assessment, test coverage, and release decisions.
- Partnered with engineering and product stakeholders to clarify expected behavior, identify risks, and validate changes.

QA Engineer I

Remote
October 2020 - October 2021

- Tested mobile features and platform changes across Android, iOS, and React Native environments for a large-scale white-label mobile platform.
- Documented actionable defects and partnered with engineers to reproduce issues, validate fixes, and assess production behavior.

Customer Success Technical Specialist (Tier 3)

Redmond, WA
March 2018 - October 2020

- Investigated complex customer escalations involving mobile application behavior, customer configurations, content, integrations, accounts, and platform workflows.
- Translated customer-reported symptoms into reproducible technical findings and partnered with engineering teams to isolate root causes and drive resolution.
- Used customer context and technical investigation to distinguish configuration issues, product defects, and expected behavior and communicate findings to technical and nontechnical stakeholders.

Earlier Pushpay roles

- App Design Specialist (December 2016 - March 2018)
- Sales Development Representative (November 2015 - December 2016)

Skills & Technical Knowledge

Quality Strategy & Leadership: Quality strategy; risk-based testing; release readiness; technical and team leadership; concurrent workstream coordination; engineering and customer-facing stakeholder communication

Quality Engineering: Test planning; manual and exploratory testing; regression, integration, and production validation; defect triage; root cause analysis; release quality assessment; shift-left quality practices

Test Automation & Web Technologies: Playwright; TypeScript; Next.js; React; GitHub Actions; cross-browser testing; CI/CD workflows; production smoke testing

Incident Response & Investigation: Production investigation; incident response; crash data, logs, build records, configuration data, APIs, and integrations; Raygun, Sumo Logic, SQL, Redash, Xcode

Delivery & Collaboration: Requirements clarification; cross-functional coordination; risk communication; process improvement; Jira, GitHub, AWS services

Mobile Platforms: Android, iOS, React Native; Apple App Store and Google Play release workflows and compliance management; TestFlight and Android Studio

Education

Florida State University

Bachelor of Science in Psychology

Tallahassee, FL
Graduated May 2013